



MyGurukul

SACRED WISDOM — SATURDAY, FEBRUARY 14, 2026



SACRED TEXT

*suvarṇacaurāḥ kaunakhyaṃ surāpaḥ śyāvadantatām | 11.49a[48Ma]
brahmahā kṣayarogitvaṃ dauścarmyaṃ gurutalpagaḥ || 49 || 11.49c[48Mc]
piśunaḥ pautināsikyaṃ sūcakaḥ pūtivaktratām | 11.50a[49Ma]
dhānyacauro 'ṅgahīnatvam ātiraikyaṃ tu miśrakaḥ || 50 || 11.50c[49Mc]*

— Manusmṛti, 11.1.3. Justification for Penance (Chapter 3), Verse 1

GURU'S INTERPRETATION

This passage from the Manusmṛti speaks plainly of the consequences of negative actions, linking specific transgressions to visible ailments. It is crucial to understand that these verses are not simply about physical punishments meted out by a divine judge. Instead, they illuminate the deeper karmic repercussions that arise from disrupting the natural order of dharma, the inherent balance of the universe. The text suggests that stealing gold leads to disfigurement, drinking intoxicants to darkened teeth, killing a Brahmin to consumption, and adultery with the guru's wife to skin diseases. Similarly, tale-bearing manifests as a foul nose, informing against someone as a foul mouth, stealing grain as missing limbs, and sexual relations with a forbidden woman as excess hair.

These pronouncements aren't literal medical diagnoses. They are symbolic representations of the inner imbalances created by these actions. Think of them as metaphors for the ways in which our choices manifest as internal suffering and external disharmony. Stealing, for example, might not literally cause a disfigured hand, but the act of taking something that isn't yours creates a distortion within your being, a sense of lack and unease that can manifest in various ways, including challenges in your physical health or relationships.

In modern life, we can interpret this as a call to cultivate awareness of our actions and their ripple effects. While we may not literally be stealing gold, are we stealing time, energy, or opportunities from others? Are we indulging in habits that darken our inner light, leading to a spiritual "disfigurement"? Are we gossiping, spreading negativity, and poisoning the atmosphere around us? The Manusmṛti urges you to examine your intentions and motivations. Every choice, no matter how small, has consequences that extend beyond the immediate moment. By acting with integrity, compassion, and a commitment to dharma, you can create a life of harmony and well-being, both for yourself and for the world around you.

REFLECTION FOR TODAY

How can you cultivate greater awareness of the subtle ways your actions impact your inner and outer well-being, and what small changes can you make today to align more closely with dharma?